

CITYAGE

PARTNER PROSPECTUS • 2026

AN URBAN PLANET CONVENING

The Next Metro Vancouver.

THE AI EDITION

Every city wants to be an AI city. Vancouver has the intrinsic assets — this is where leaders are making British Columbia's AI future happen.

49°17'N

PACIFIC GATEWAY

AUTUMN 2026

URBAN PLANET SERIES
VANCOUVER FLAGSHIP

CITYAGE.COM
VANCOUVER, BRITISH COLUMBIA

The assets are intrinsic. The decision isn't.

In the AI economy, the scarce inputs are clean power, deep talent, trusted institutions and a place people want to live. Vancouver has all four. *What it doesn't yet have is the decision to use them.*

The AI build-out is the largest infrastructure race of the era, and it runs on things that cannot be conjured: abundant clean electricity, cool climates, research universities, global talent pipelines, and the quality of life that makes that talent stay. These are not policies. They are endowments — and Metro Vancouver holds a remarkable concentration of them.

Hydroelectric power among the cleanest on the continent. A research bench at UBC and SFU with decades of machine-learning pedigree. The deepest visual-effects, animation and gaming talent pool in the country. An immigration system that admits the engineers other jurisdictions turn away. And the Pacific position: the gateway between North American compute and Asian markets.

What the region lacks is not raw material but conversion: the anchor investments, the policy clarity, and the shared ambition to turn an enviable position into a defining industry. Toronto claimed the research crown. Seattle and the Bay Area claimed the capital. Vancouver's window to claim its own seat is open — and windows like this one do not stay open.

The Next Metro Vancouver: The AI Edition convenes the people who can make the conversion — the premiers and mayors, the utility and port executives, the founders, the chairs of the research bench, the institutional capital — for one editorially curated afternoon under the Urban Planet thesis: consequential decisions are made in cities, and this one is due.

15

YEARS CONVENING
DECISION-MAKERS

100+

CITYGATE EVENTS ACROSS
NORTH AMERICA

25,000

VERIFIED DECISION-MAKERS
IN THE NETWORK

Five questions, one afternoon.

The program is editorially curated — built like a magazine issue, not a trade show. Five questions that decide whether Vancouver becomes an AI city, each examined in a moderated fireside with the people closest to the answer.

1 The power question

AI runs on electricity, and BC's hydro is among the cleanest on Earth. Can the grid host the data centres and compute the industry needs — and should it? The utility, the regulators and the builders, at one table.

2 The talent question

UBC and SFU produce the researchers; the VFX, gaming and animation studios have built the deepest digital talent pool in Canada; immigration policy admits the engineers others turn away. How does the region keep that talent from boarding flights to Seattle and San Francisco?

3 The capital question

Research without anchor investment stays research. What it takes to land the flagship labs, the institutional capital and the first decisive bets — and what the region must offer to win them.

4 The application question

Vancouver's fastest path may not be building frontier models but applying AI to what the region already does at world scale: the port and its supply chains, the resource economy, film and media, life sciences. The companies doing it now, and what they need next.

5 The position question

Between Seattle's giants and Asia's markets, on the Cascadia corridor, in the time zone of the Pacific century: how Vancouver turns geography into strategy — partner to the giants without becoming their branch plant.

Curated by editors, not underwriters.

The Next Metro Vancouver is invitation-led. Seats are curated the way a correspondent builds a source list: for what each person knows, decides or controls — never for what they paid. The room is assembled from five constituencies:

Government

Provincial ministers, mayors and senior officials with files in technology, energy, trade and immigration.

Founders & Operators

The AI founders building here, and the studio, gaming and life-science operators who employ the region's digital talent at scale.

Power & Infrastructure

The utility, the port, the data-centre builders and the infrastructure investors who decide what physically gets built.

Capital

Venture, pension and institutional investors weighing the region — including the ones who haven't committed yet.

The Research Bench

University leadership and the machine-learning researchers whose work the whole thesis rests on.

Names and program to be announced through autumn 2026, drawn from the speaker bench of fifteen years of CityAge convenings in this region.

What a partner actually gets.

Partnerships are limited by design — a small number per convening, each aligned with one of the five questions. Partners shape the questions on the table. They do not buy the answers.

TIER 01 • ONE PER EVENT

Title Partner

Your name on the convening itself. First position in all editorial and campaign material, a seat in the program's framing conversation, a private pre-event dinner with speakers, and a curated introduction list built from the room. The title partner is in the story, not beside it.

TIER 02 • ONE PER QUESTION

Knowledge Partner

Ownership of one of the five questions: input on its framing, a voice in its fireside, and the post-event intelligence brief carrying your name to the full CityAge network.

TIER 03 • THE PREMIUM INSTRUMENT

Micro-Network

The most concentrated product CityAge makes: eight to twelve principals, personally curated by the publisher around your single objective, convened privately alongside the main event. No stage, no audience — just the right table.

Every tier includes presence in the event's editorial coverage and the post-event brief distributed to CityAge's network of 25,000 verified decision-makers. The partnership schedule, with investment levels, is available on request.

Why this room holds.

Convening authority cannot be bought; it is earned over time, in print and in person. The Next Metro Vancouver is led by CityAge founder Miro Cernetig, whose three decades in journalism are the platform's credibility anchor — including years covering this city and this coast.

Bureau Chief, The Globe and Mail

BEIJING • NEW YORK • THE ARCTIC •
VANCOUVER

Michener Award

CANADA'S HIGHEST HONOUR FOR PUBLIC-
SERVICE JOURNALISM

Coverage spanning Gorbachev to
Thatcher

FOUR DECADES REPORTING ON THE PEOPLE WHO
RUN THE WORLD

That record is reinforced by fifteen years of CityAge convenings: more than one hundred events across North America, a verified network of twenty-five thousand decision-makers, and a 2026 Ottawa summit that put ambassadors, military commanders and northern leaders on the same stage.

Vancouver is where CityAge lives. This convening is the company's home game — programmed with the institutional memory of fifteen years of rooms in this region.

"We are not retained by the industries we cover. The room is curated by editors, not underwriters — that is the entire value of the room."

The AI century needs cities. *This one is deciding whether to show up.*

Title and knowledge partnerships for The Next Metro Vancouver: The AI Edition are being placed now, in conversation with a short list of organizations whose work aligns with the five questions. The first conversation is thirty minutes with the publisher.

Autumn

2026 • VANCOUVER

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QUESTIONS • EDITORIALY CURATED

I

TITLE PARTNERSHIP AVAILABLE

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